Work Sample - Backtest Verification

Independent checks on published backtest numbers: sample, selection, multiple testing.
Every claim below links to a public artifact.
Updated 2026-11-08 | rytjy

METHOD

A backtest number is only as good as its denominator. I rebuild the sample, count the trials, split in and out of sample, and check whether the code computes what its docstring says. Findings are written as a reproducible script plus a short report, and I retract my own numbers when the input changes.

Three samples

Sample	Check	Outcome
polars-anta	skewness/kurtosis bias vs docstring	Confirmed by maintainer; PR #34
C2 screen	37 strategies rebuilt independently	Arithmetic ok; 19 concentration flags
Case 13	PBO after data-loading fix	73.33% to 46.67%, retracted publicly

READING

Sample 1: the library returned population moments while documenting sample estimators. I verified it on a known window and sent the formulas; the maintainer confirmed and asked for a patch. Added a bias flag, 7 NumPy-referenced tests, 221 tests pass. Sample 2: rebuilt every monthly table from 37 public strategies. Compounding matches the platform within 0.4 pp, so the arithmetic is not the issue; the risk sits in concentration (19 of 37 above 70% from the top three months) and short history. Sample 3: my first PBO came from a half-loaded sample; after the maintainer fixed loading, the same script gave 46.67%. I published the correction and the reason.

REPRODUCE

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Links: github.com/huuan26/polars-anta/pull/34 | github.com/rytjy/backtest-audit-kit |
pypi.org/project/backtest-audit-kit
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SCOPE AND LIMITS

No live trading performance is claimed; all numbers come from backtests or public datasets.
Scope, price and delivery time are agreed in writing before work starts.
If a check cannot be run on the available data, the report says so instead of estimating.